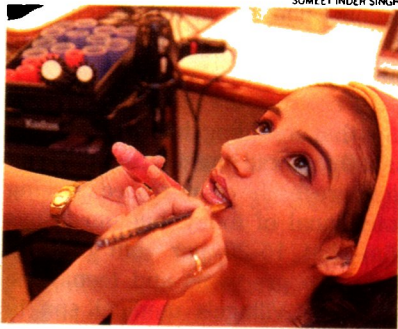


## TEEN MAKEOVERS

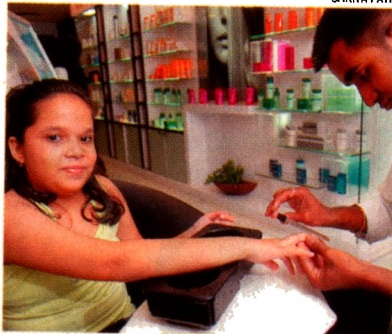
SUMEETINDER SINGH

**Mansi Malhotra, 17 years**

A student of GD Goenka School in Delhi, Mansi loves to go pubbing with her friends. For the last four years she has been getting her body waxed (including a bikini wax) and her hair braided. From the time she was 15, her beauty regime includes facials and hair-styling. She visits the salon at least thrice a month and her average spend per visit is Rs 1,500-1,600.

**"Looking good is very important and my mom is cool as long as studies don't suffer."**

SHRIYA PATIL

**Saksha M, 10 years  
Aakansha M, 14 years**

The two sisters visit Franck Provost spa for at least a couple of times in a month. While it's more manicure and hairstyling for the younger one, Aakansha is more experimental with facials and spa treatments.

**"I love the feel of my clean freshly manicured nails."** SAKSHA

**"All my friends go to parlours to get different things done."** AAKANSHA

**FEEL GOOD: Eight-year-old Goonj at Cleopatra Salon in Chandigarh**

children from now, so we give free vouchers to the parents initially and then they start to come on their own." Adds Arpita Mehta, manager of Franck Provost Spa in Mumbai: "Once we noticed that lots of children were streaming in during the summer holidays. We decided to offer them special discounts and packages."

Even birthday parties are no longer about streamers and frills. They are being celebrated in swish salons and spas across urban India. Manvi Singhee, a class IV student, celebrated her birthday in style at A Cut Above Children, an exclusive salon attached to Saveria Hotel in Chennai. With her girlfriends, Manvi celebrated her sixth birthday with a beauty salon party where the salon staff and therapists pampered their senses. "They got themselves a manicure and pedicure, styled their hair and got their nails painted and tattooed too," says Manisha Singhee, Manvi's mother, who organised the party. As take-aways, the children got vanity cases containing a nail polish, lip gloss and lipstick. A Cut Above Children started six years ago primarily to cater to children's whims and fancies.

Manvi and her friends may have

**"Children walk in with their mothers for surgery. Today's society is largely driven by what children want."**

DR MILIND WAGH,  
COSMETIC SURGEON

had a blast but what the parents may not know is that it may sow seeds of serious disorders in their little ones. As Prabhjot Malhi, child psychologist at Post Graduate Institute of Medical Education and Research, Chandigarh, says: "Teenagers are not cognitively mature for beauty-enhancing treatments. It interferes with the child's development, fostering narcissism at a young age, which makes children emotionally vulnerable."

In a country where 475 million are under 20 years of age and some 300 million are under 15 years, it makes sense to sell a pipe dream to these naive kids. Be it spas and salons or high-end fashion brands, everyone is looking at tapping this segment. The grooming market in India is estimated to be between Rs 8,000-10,000 crore. Of this, the children's market (12-16